

An Eighth 'Transformers' Movie Is in the Works, With Steven Spielberg Helping Lead

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The giant robots are getting ready to roll out again. Paramount Pictures is working on an eighth "Transformers" movie, according to the film news site IndieWire.

The "Transformers" movies are based on Hasbro toys of robots that can change into cars, trucks and other machines. The films have earned about \$5.4 billion at movie theaters around the world.

The biggest news is that famous filmmaker Steven Spielberg has joined the project as an **executive producer**. That means he will help lead the movie's creative direction, along with producer Lorenzo di Bonaventura. Spielberg was also an **executive producer** on the original "Transformers" films. He signed on after reading the **script**.

Writer Jason Fuchs is working on a **script** that aims to return to the spirit of the original movies. The new film will be set in modern times, but details about the story are being kept secret.

Michael Bay, who directed the first five "Transformers" movies, is in early talks to direct again, IndieWire reports. Nothing is final yet. Shia LaBeouf, the star of the first films, will not return. IndieWire says it is too early for news about the rest of the cast.

The movie is one of the first big projects for Dana Goldberg and Josh Greenstein, the Skydance film chiefs, now that a **merger** between Paramount and Warner Bros. Discovery is complete. IndieWire says the two made meeting with Spielberg one of their first goals in August.

Recent movies in the series did not reach the more than \$1 billion earned by 2014's "Transformers: Age of Extinction." They include the **spinoff** "Bumblebee," "Transformers: Rise of the Beasts" and the animated "Transformers One" from 2024. A planned **crossover** with "G.I. Joe" is not moving forward, IndieWire learned.

Word Treasure

executive producer -- A person who helps guide and oversee a movie or show, often its big creative or business choices.

script -- The written text of a movie, including what the characters say and do.

spinoff -- A new movie or show built around characters or ideas from an earlier one.

merger -- When two companies join together to become one.

crossover -- A story that brings together characters from two different series.

Background you need

Transformers began as Hasbro toys of robots that can change into vehicles and other machines, and they later became cartoons, comics and live-action movies.

Movie studios often keep making new films in a successful series, called a franchise, because fans already know the characters.

An executive producer helps guide a film's big decisions, while the director leads the actual filming.

When film companies merge, new leaders often choose well-known franchises for some of their first projects.

Break it down

LEAD: The giant robots are returning in an eighth Transformers movie

KEY EVENT: Paramount develops the film with Steven Spielberg as executive producer

+ - WHO: Spielberg, producer Lorenzo di Bonaventura, writer Jason Fuchs

+ - WHAT: A modern-day story aiming for the spirit of the original films

+ - SOURCE: IndieWire report

DETAILS: Michael Bay in early talks to direct; Shia LaBeouf not returning

CONTEXT: First big project for Skydance film chiefs after the Paramount-Warner Bros. Discovery merger

OPEN QUESTION: Who will direct and star; recent films earned less than the series' peak

Why it matters

Transformers is one of the biggest movie series of this century, so its next step matters to fans and to the studio's new leaders. It shows how studios try to bring back popular franchises by returning to what audiences first loved.

Test what you remember

1. Which number Transformers movie is Paramount working on?

- ☐ (A) The sixth
- ☐ (B) The fifth
- ☐ (C) The eighth
- ☐ (D) The tenth

2. What role has Steven Spielberg taken on?

- ☐ (A) Composer
- ☐ (B) Executive producer
- ☐ (C) Lead actor
- ☐ (D) Director

3. What are the Transformers movies based on?

- ☐ (A) Hasbro toys of robots that change into machines
- ☐ (B) A famous novel
- ☐ (C) A true story
- ☐ (D) A video game

4. About how much have the films earned around the world?

- ☐ (A) \$1 billion
- ☐ (B) \$30 billion
- ☐ (C) \$129 million
- ☐ (D) \$5.4 billion

5. What is true about Michael Bay?

- ☐ (A) He is in early talks to direct again
- ☐ (B) He wrote the script
- ☐ (C) He has signed to direct
- ☐ (D) He refused to be involved

6. Which planned project is not moving forward?

- ☐ (A) A theme park ride
- ☐ (B) A Bumblebee sequel
- ☐ (C) An animated series
- ☐ (D) A Transformers and G.I. Joe crossover

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: A 4: D 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):